



September 23, 2025

Village of Saranac Lake
Community Development Office
39 Main St., Suite 9
Saranac Lake, NY 129853

Re: Support for Village of Saranac Lake Smart Growth Grant Application – Lake Colby Beach House Accessibility Upgrades (Contractual Services)

Dear Review Committee,

As President of the Saranac Lake Fish and Game Club, I am proud to express strong support for the Village of Saranac Lake's Smart Growth Grant application to fund contractual services for accessibility upgrades at the Lake Colby Beach House.

Lake Colby is home to our Colby Classic Ice Fishing Derby, one of Saranac Lake's most popular annual winter events. Each year, hundreds of participants and visitors from across the North Country and beyond come to enjoy this tournament, bringing significant economic and cultural benefits to our community. The Lake Colby Beach House serves as the central hub for registration, weigh-ins, and participant services during the derby.

The Saranac Lake Fish & Game Club also organizes an annual Youth Fishing Derby on Father's Day at Lake Colby, which is free to all community participants.

Unfortunately, the current lack of ADA-compliant facilities limits the accessibility and comfort of these events for individuals with mobility challenges. With support from this grant, the Village will be able to contract the professional design, engineering, and construction services needed to modernize the Beach House with accessible bathrooms, improved pathways, and functional upgrades. These improvements will enhance not only summer use of the beach but also year-round activities such as the Colby Classic.

This project ensures that long-standing community traditions, like ice fishing & other derbies, remain inclusive, welcoming, and sustainable for future generations. It also strengthens Franklin County's appeal as a four-season recreation destination.

The Saranac Lake Fish and Game Club fully supports this application and urges your strongest consideration.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "Tom Cleator", with a stylized flourish at the end.

Tom Cleator, President
Saranac Lake Fish and Game Club

Cc: FILE